

Jonathan Eaton, PhD

Socio-cultural Anthropologist

Disaster Resilience Research Network
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CURRENT POSITION

2022 - Executive Director, Disaster Resilience Research Network, and Postdoctoral Fellow,
Department of Civil Engineering, University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada

EDUCATION

- 2025 **PhD in Anthropology, University of British Columbia (UBC)**
Dissertation title: Anticipating disaster: Uncertainty, heritage, and place-making in
Vancouver, Canada (<https://doi.org/10.14288/1.0447124>)
Supervisor: Dr. Sara Shneiderman
- 2011 **Master of Arts in Anthropology, University of Toronto**
MRP title: Trauma and Recovery: Re-Signifying Communist-era Sites of Memory in
Contemporary Albania
Supervisor: Dr. Lena Mortensen
- 2009 **Bachelor of Arts in History, summa cum laude, Valparaiso University**
Valparaiso, Indiana
Minors in Humanities and Classical Languages
Christ College Scholar (interdisciplinary honors program)
International Studies Program in Cambridge, UK

PUBLICATIONS

PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES

Milne, C., T. Legere, **J. Eaton**, S. Shneiderman, and C. Molina Hutt. 2024. The state of disaster and resilience literature in British Columbia, Canada. A systematic scoping review. *International Journal of Disaster Risk Reduction* 113. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijdr.2024.104848>

Eaton, J. and M. Turin. 2022. Heritage Languages and Language as Heritage: The Language of Heritage in Canada and Beyond. *International Journal of Heritage Studies* 28(7). <https://doi.org/10.1080/13527258.2022.2077805>

Eaton, J. and E. Roshi. 2014. Chiseling away at a concrete legacy: Engaging with Communist-era heritage and memory in Albania. *Journal of Field Archaeology* 39(3), 312-319. <https://doi.org/10.1179/0093469014Z.00000000084>

BOOK CHAPTERS

Eaton, J. 2022. Austrian Economics on Mushrooms: A Mycelial Approach to Understanding Market Processes in Pre-Disaster Recovery Planning in Vancouver, Canada. In *Market Process and Market Order: Key Contributions*. Eds. Christopher Coyne, Rosolino Candela and Kristen Collins. Lanham, MD: Rowman & Littlefield.

Rocker, K. and **J. Eaton**. 2022. Acting Out the Future of the Albanian National Theatre: New Heritage at the Intersection of Resistance and New Media. In *Theorizing Heritage through Non-Violent Resistance*. Eds. Evren Uzer and Feras Hammami. London: Palgrave, 41-69. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-77708-1_3

Hadžić, L. and **J. Eaton**. 2017. Rebuilding the Broken: Regional Restoration Camps as a Meeting Platform in the Western Balkans. In *Heritage and Peacebuilding*. Eds. Diana Walters, Daniel Laven and Peter Davis. Suffolk, UK: Boydell & Brewer, 205-219.

REVIEWS

Eaton, J. Forthcoming. Review of *Free Gifts: Capitalism and the Politics of Nature* by Alyssa Battistoni. *Journal of Disaster Studies*.

Eaton, J. 2021. Living with Earthquakes, Past and Future. Review of *Shake Up* and *A Future for Memory*, Museum of Anthropology, University of British Columbia. *Visual Anthropology Review* 37(2), 463-469. <https://doi.org/10.1111/var.12252>

CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

Eaton, J., M. Bllaci, N. Petri, L. Hadžić, and E. Mamani. 2018. Heritage-making and Democratic Ideals in Albania: Spaç Prison as a Site of Dialogue. New Delhi, India. *Proceedings of the 19th ICOMOS General Assembly and Scientific Symposium*.

Hadžić, L., E. Mamani, M. Bllaci, **J. Eaton**, and R. Eppich 2018. Hands-on Cooperation: The Regional Restoration Camps Experience in the Balkans. New Delhi, India. *Proceedings of the 19th ICOMOS General Assembly and Scientific Symposium*.

Eaton, J. and L. Hadžić. 2014. Restoration, Reconciliation, Hopes for the Future: Cultural Heritage without Borders – 17 years in the Western Balkans. In *The Politics of Heritage and Memory*. Zagreb: University of Zagreb.

REPORTS AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

Eaton, J., I. Poshyvailo and A. Tandon. 2026. General Guidelines on Risk Reduction, Emergency Preparedness, and First Aid for World Heritage Properties and Sites on the Tentative List in Ukraine. UNESCO, ICOMOS, and ICCROM.

Eaton, J., R. Somani, H. C. Ip, M. Hooper, T. Lim, and S. Shneiderman. 2025. Understanding Disaster Preparedness in Vancouver: Community Perspectives”. Vancouver: UBC Disaster Resilience Research Network (DRRN) and the City of Vancouver Emergency Management Agency (VEMA). doi: [10.14288/1.0450052](https://doi.org/10.14288/1.0450052)

Eaton, J. and S. Shneiderman. 2023 As we fight the Alberta and B.C. wildfires, we must also plan for future disasters. *The Conversation*. May 19. <https://theconversation.com/as-we-fight-the-alberta-and-b-c-wildfires-we-must-also-plan-for-future-disasters-205818>

Eaton, J. 2016. The Consequences of Neglect: Confronting Neglected Heritage as an Integral Part of Emergency Preparedness and Response. *e-dialogos* 5, 42-51.

Bllaci, M., **J. Eaton**, N. Petri, and K. Rocker. 2016. A Dialogue Toolkit: Tips and Techniques from the Dialogues for Spaç Project. Cultural Heritage without Borders-Albania and the International Coalition of Sites of Conscience. Available at: <https://www.sitesofconscience.org/wp-content/uploads/2018/08/Spac-Toolkit-2017-Final.pdf>

Hoxha, Gj., I. Mejzini, F. Caka, eds. With R. Jigyasu, A. Tandon, C. Antomarchi, **J. Eaton**, M. Jaramillo Contreras, S. Boshtrakaj, V. Aliu, and Y. Vokshi. 2015. Guide for First Aid on Built Heritage in Kosovo. Prishtina, Kosovo: SAS. (with Gj. Hoxha,)

Eaton, J., ed. 2015. Overview Report of the Nepal Cultural Emergency Crowdmapping Initiative. Available at: <https://www.iccrom.org/news/nepal-cultural-emergency-report>

Battisti, S. and **J. Eaton**. 2015. Tirana: Life After Demolition. *Clog: Landmark*.

Hashimoto, T., **J. Eaton**, and M. Dulaku. 2010. Voice of the Western Balkans, Voice of Europe. *Tirana Times*, 7.

MUSEUM/HERITAGE EXHIBITIONS

2018. Project lead. Interpretation of the Castle of Gjirokastra. Gjirokastra, Albania.

2009. Curator. Exhibition of Jordanian pottery. Brauer Museum of Art. Valparaiso University, Valparaiso, IN.

GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

2022	UBC Department of Anthropology Dissertation Writing Award
2019 - 2022	Vanier Canada Graduate Scholarship, Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada
2019 - 2022	UBC Public Scholars Initiative
2018 - 2023	UBC Four Year Fellowships (FYF) For PhD Students
2020 - 2021	UBC President's Academic Excellence Initiative PhD Award
2019 - 2021	Adam Smith Fellowship, Mercatus Center, George Mason Univ.
2019	UBC Faculty of Arts Graduate Student Research Award
2018 - 2019	UBC Faculty of Arts Graduate Award
2015	Andreas Ådahl Scholarship
2011 - 2012	American Councils Title VIII Southeast European Language and Research Fellowship
2010 - 2011	University of Toronto Faculty of Arts and Sciences Graduate Studies Fellowship
2009 - 2010	J. William Fulbright Award, Albania
2009	Joseph-Armand Bombardier Canada Graduate Scholarship - Master's (declined)
2009	Marvel Stockwell Scholarship from Pi Gamma Mu

AWARDS AND HONORS

2025	Hazards and Disasters Student Paper Competition, Natural Hazards Center, University of Colorado - Winner
2025	Erve Chambers Heritage & Tourism Student Paper Award - Honorable Mention
2014	European Union Prize for Cultural Heritage / Europa Nostra Award in the category of "Education, Training and Awareness-raising" (with Cultural Heritage without Borders - Albania)
2009	Phi Beta Kappa, academic honor society

CONFERENCES, SEMINARS AND WORKSHOPS

CONFERENCES AND PANELS ORGANIZED

2025	Panel organizer and chair. The Future is a Foreign Country: Operationalizing and Acting on the World to Come. American Anthropological Association (AAA) Annual Meeting. November 19-23. New Orleans, LA.
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- 2021 Conference organizer and session chair. Un/Predictable Environments: Politics, Ecology, Agency. International virtual conference. May 20-21. Vancouver, Canada. Supervised 4 staff.
- 2014 - 2017 Conference organizer and facilitator. Balkan Museum Network Annual Conference "Meet, See, Do." Multi-day international conference. Tirana, Albania (2014); Novi Sad, Serbia (2015); Shkodra, Albania (2016); Prishtina, Kosovo (2017).

WORKSHOPS AND SEMINARS ORGANIZED

- 2022 - 2025 UBC Disaster Resilience Research Network organizational planning workshops. December 2022, September 2023, April 2024, May 2025. University of British Columbia, Vancouver, BC.
- 2024 Two-week Regional Restoration Camp on oral history and interpretive trails. Cultural Heritage without Borders, Gjirokastra, Albania.
- 2021 Emergency Response and Salvage for Cultural Institutions. BC Heritage Emergency Response Network (BC HERN). April 18 - 19. Virtual workshop.
- 2018 Connecting South Asian and Himalayan Research Communities Across Cascadia. November 2 - 3. University of British Columbia, Vancouver, BC.
- 2018 Beyond the Grave: A Symposium on the Politics of Dead Bodies in (Post)Socialist Albania. Tirana, Albania.
- 2016 - 2018 CHwB Regional Restoration Camps. Two-week intensive hands-on heritage training. July 2016, July 2017, June 2018. Shkodra, Albania.
- 2016 International Course on Disaster Risk Management for Cultural Heritage. Balkan Cultural Aid Response for Emergencies (B+CARE). November 7 - 27. Sarajevo, Bosnia and Herzegovina; Prishtina, Kosovo; Gjirokastra, Albania.
- 2016 Volunteer Training on First Aid for Cultural Heritage. Balkan Cultural Aid Response for Emergencies (B+CARE). March 14 - 18. Gjirokastra, Albania.
- 2014 Dialogues for Spaç Prison. Series of multi-day workshops. Documenting and understanding (June), Visioning (October), Planning (December)

INVITED RESEARCH TALKS

- 2025 Disaster Planning and Heritage: Imagining Earthquake Aftermaths in Vancouver. May 8. Vancouver Heritage Foundation. Vancouver, Canada.
- 2025 From Albania to Appleton and In Between: How to Use an Anthropology Degree (or Two). May 5. Lawrence Anthropology Society, Lawrence University. Appleton, WI

- 2022 Culture and Disasters: A View from Anthropology. November 16. Dunbar Earthquake and Emergency Preparedness (DEEP). Vancouver, Canada.
- 2021 Research presentation to City of Vancouver Sustainability Group. October 26. Vancouver, Canada.

INVITED PROFESSIONAL TALKS

- 2018 Living communities, living heritage. Presentation and workshop. UNESCO World Heritage Youth Forum. June 18. Bahrain.
- 2018 From Mines to Mind-maps: A Dialogue-based Approach to Museum Planning at Spaç Prison. Network of European Museum Organizations (NEMO) Webinar. June 25. Tirana, Albania.
- 2018 Heritage-making for the Future: Unlocking Dialogue and Action at Spaç Prison. Widening the Debate on the Cultural Heritage of the Dictatorship in Albania. May 25. Tirana, Albania.
- 2016 Restoring and Building Relations: Heritage for Building Peace. International course on Building National Capacities in First Aid and Risk Management for Cultural Heritage in Times of Conflict. October 30. ICCROM-ATHAR Regional Conservation Center, Sharjah, United Arab Emirates.
- 2016 Taking Action: First Aiders After FAC and Restoring and Building Relations: Planning for Post-Conflict Recovery. International course on First Aid for Cultural Heritage in Times of Crisis. June 24. Washington, DC.
- 2016 Public debate: Heritage and Identity Politics in Wars and Conflicts. April 18. Gothenburg, Sweden.
- 2016 Lessons Learned from the Balkan Experience: Our Approach to Cultural Tourism. Regional Ecotourism Initiative. Community Ecotourism Training. March 3. Lotan, Israel.
- 2015 Heritage, Cross-cultural Conflict and Development: Lessons Learned from the Balkan Experience. Regional Ecotourism Initiative, Expert Meeting. February 13. Madaba, Jordan.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2025 Heritage in Recovery: Shifting perspectives on making place amidst disaster potentiality in Vancouver, Canada. Society for Applied Anthropology (SfAA) Annual Meeting. March 25 - 29. Portland, OR.
- 2023 Retrofitting Vancouver: How Deep Earth and Deep Time Shape the City. American Anthropological Association (AAA) Annual Meeting. November 15-19. Toronto, ON.

- 2023 Converging Crises and Diverging Temporalities in Vancouver, Canada. Society for Applied Anthropology (SfAA) Annual Meeting. March 28-April 1. Cincinnati, OH.
- 2022 What is the greenest building? Imagining Housing, Heritage, and the Future of the Built Landscape in Vancouver, Canada. American Anthropological Association (AAA) Annual Meeting. November 9-13. Seattle, WA.
- 2021 Rebuilding the Future: Disaster Anticipation and Recovery Planning in Vancouver, Canada. The Northern European Conference on Emergency and Disaster Studies (NEEDS). September 21-23. Östersund, Sweden.
- 2021 Converging Crises and Seismic Uncertainty in Vancouver, Canada. Un/Predictable Environments: Politics, Ecology, Agency. May 20-21. Vancouver, Canada.
- 2019 Projecting dystopia: Art and the right to the city. American Anthropological Association (AAA) / Canadian Anthropology Society (CASCA). November 20 - 24. Vancouver, Canada.
- 2017 Balkan Cultural Aid Response for Emergencies (B+CARE). First Aid for Culture Design Workshop. October 16 - 20. ICCROM, Rome, Italy.
- 2017 Heritage-making and Democratic Ideals in Albania: Spaç Prison as a Site of Dialogue. 19th ICOMOS General Assembly and Scientific Symposium. December 11 - 15. New Delhi, India.
- 2013 Challenges and Opportunities for Sustainable Cultural Heritage Regeneration in a Post-Conflict Kosovo. Annual conference of the International National Trust Organization. September 29 - October 3. Entebbe, Uganda.
- 2013 Restoration, Reconciliation, Hopes for the Future: Cultural Heritage without Borders: 17 Years in the Western Balkans. The Politics of Heritage & Memory. October 9. Zadar, Croatia.
- 2011 Museums, Indigeneity and Crises of Identity in the Western Balkans. World Archaeological Congress, Inter-Congress. June 22 - 25. Indianapolis, IN, USA.
- 2009 Understanding History: Interpreting the Past through the Interpretations of Others. National Conference on Undergraduate Research (NCUR). April 16 - 18. LaCrosse, WI, USA.
- 2008 Receptive Agnosticism and the Scientific Method: Reconciling Faith and Science within Biblical Archaeology. National Conference on Undergraduate Research (NCUR). April 10 - 12. Salisbury, MD, USA.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- 2025 ANTH110: Introduction to Cultural Anthropology, Instructor of Record, Department of Anthropology, Lawrence University, Appleton, WI
- 2022 ANTH100: Introduction to Cultural Anthropology, Graduate Teaching Assistant (planning, leading, and grading for 3 seminar-style tutorials, weekly), Department of Anthropology, University of British Columbia, Vancouver, BC
- 2010 - 2011 ANT204: Anthropology in the Contemporary World, Graduate Teaching Assistant (planning and leading tutorials, grading), Department of Anthropology, University of Toronto, Toronto, ON

SERVICE AND PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

- 2025 - Founding member of Canadian National Trust Disaster Working Group
- 2018 - Double blind peer review for *International Journal of Heritage Studies* (3), *Irish Journal of Anthropology* (2), *Geoforum* (1), *East European Politics and Societies* (1) and *Politics, Religion and Ideology* (1)
- 2018 - 2025 Anthropology Graduate Student Association (AGSA), University of British Columbia; Vice President (2020-2021); produced study and report on COVID-19 impacts on current graduate students; represented graduate students on task force to resolve role of students on tenure-track faculty hiring committees; mentored incoming graduate students, including 3 winners of the Vanier CGS and 1 winner of the Frédéric Bastiat Fellowship
- 2023 Co-organized a series of public “Reading Room” seminars on heritage and disasters with Heritage Vancouver Society
- 2022 Desk review and commentary on risk preparedness for UNESCO World Heritage nomination on behalf of ICOMOS-ICORP
- 2021 - 2022 Volunteer, Emergency Support Services, Vancouver, BC
- 2019 - 2021 Reviewer of nominations for World Monuments Fund Watch List
- 2018 Participant, “International Leadership Course on First Aid to Cultural Heritage in Times of Crisis,” Brabant, Netherlands, 24-31 August, organized by ICCROM, Prince Claus Fund, Smithsonian Institution, and UNESCO Netherlands
- 2018 Participant in developmental evaluation of the Regional Restoration Camps, the flagship program of Cultural Heritage without Borders - Albania
- 2015 Participant, International Course “First Aid for Cultural Heritage in Times of Crisis,” Amsterdam, Netherlands, 30 March - 24 April, organized by ICCROM, Prince Claus Fund, Smithsonian Institution, and UNESCO Netherlands

2012	External Reviewer, Fulbright/Humphrey Award Selection Committee, US Embassy in Albania
2010 - 2011	Volunteer, World Cultures Department, Royal Ontario Museum, Toronto
2007	Volunteer, Coins and Medals Department, Fitzwilliam Museum, University of Cambridge, Cambridge, UK

MEDIA COVERAGE

2022 -	Facilitated media engagement with members of UBC Disaster Resilience Research Network
2025	Interviews for <i>CTV</i> and <i>The Conversation Lab</i>
2023	Commentary published in <i>The Conversation</i> and republished in <i>The Tyee</i>
2023	Interview on live radio for <i>QR Calgary</i>
2023	Interview for <i>Modern Farmer</i> article, titled "Canada's Wildfires Threaten Its Farmers From All Sides"

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2025 -	Mixed-methods, interdisciplinary study on emergency preparedness and risk management on the campus of the University of British Columbia and surroundings, in partnership with UBC Safety and Risk Services; surveys conducted with Qualtrics; qualitative analysis conducted with Nvivo.
2024 - 2026	Mixed-methods, interdisciplinary study on emergency preparedness and risk perception in Vancouver, in partnership with the City of Vancouver Emergency Management Agency; surveys conducted with Qualtrics; qualitative analysis conducted with Nvivo.
2020 - 2021	Ethnographic dissertation fieldwork in Vancouver, Canada, "Anticipating disaster: Uncertainty, heritage, and place-making in Vancouver"; qualitative analysis conducted with Atlas.ti
2019 - 2020	Research Assistant, "Expertise, Labour and Mobility in Nepal's Post-Conflict, Post-Disaster Reconstruction," University of British Columbia
2018 - 2020	Research Assistant, "From Nepal to Vancouver: An Ethnographic Scoping Exercise & Knowledge Exchange Event about Earthquakes, Heritage & Governance," University of British Columbia
2019	Pre-dissertation scoping fieldwork in Nepal and Louisiana
2018	Research Assistant, "Connecting South Asian & Himalayan Research Communities Across Cascadia," University of British Columbia

2009 - 2010 Fulbright Scholar (Albania), MA fieldwork on communist-era heritage

2008 Library Research Assistant / Smithsonian Institution Katzenberger Intern,
Cooper-Hewitt National Design Museum, New York, NY

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2025 - Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Department of Civil Engineering, and Executive Director, Disaster Resilience Research Network (DRRN), University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada

2024 - 2025 Consulting for the International Centre for the Study of the Preservation and Restoration of Cultural Property (ICCROM), First Aid and Resilience for Cultural Heritage in Times of Crisis (FAR) program

2022 - 2024 Coordinator, Disaster Resilience Research Network (DRRN), University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada

2023 - 2024 Consulting for Cultural Heritage without Borders - Albania (CHWB-Albania) on "The Drino Valley Monasteries Cultural Routes: Connecting Rural Communities"

2012 - 2018 Program Officer, Cultural Heritage without Borders - Albania (CHWB), Tirana, Albania

2011 - 2012 Museum Consultant, Gjirokastra Conservation and Development Organization, Gjirokastra, Albania

LANGUAGES

English (native) | **Albanian** (working fluency) | **Spanish** (intermediate)

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

2025 - Canadian National Trust Disaster Working Group

2022 - American Anthropological Association (AAA)

2022 - Society for Applied Anthropology (SfAA)

2016 - Associate Member, ICOMOS International Committee on Risk Preparedness (ICORP)

2015 - International Council on Monuments and Sites (ICOMOS)

REFERENCES

Professional and academic references available upon request.